

Ἀμύντας ὁ Τελμησσεύς

Amyntas of Telmessos and the Elegiac Tradition

eul_aid: gxg

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Amyntas of Telmessos was a Greek epigrammatist of the 4th century BCE. He originated from Telmessos, a city in Lycia in southwestern Asia Minor. No biographical details about his life are recorded beyond this origin and his single surviving poem.

His only known work is the Epigram for the Dog Tauron, a single elegiac couplet preserved in the Greek Anthology. The poem is an epitaph mourning Tauron, a hunting dog killed by a boar.

Amyntas is a minor but notable figure within the Hellenistic epigram tradition. His sole surviving poem is an early example of an epitaph for a pet, illustrating the genre's expansion to commemorate animals valued for service and companionship. It contributes to understanding the personal themes and range of subject matter in epigrammatic poetry.

Works (1)

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